

Website Design, SEO & Hosting Agreement

This document sets out what we will build, what it costs, and how we work together, so there are no surprises later. Read it, fill in the details, and sign at the bottom. Work starts once this is signed and the deposit is paid.

1 Who this is between

SERVICE PROVIDER

Business / name

[Your business name]

Contact person

[Your name]

Email / phone

[Your contact]

CLIENT

Business / name

[Client business]

Contact person

[Client name]

Email / phone

[Client contact]

Agreement date: [DD / MM / YYYY] Website / project: [website address or projec

2 What is included

The work covered by this agreement:

- Design and build of the website described above.
- Ongoing search engine optimisation (SEO) work, at [e.g. X hours] per month.
- [number] rounds of revisions per month included in the monthly fee.
- Keeping the live website online and maintained on the hosting described in section 4.
- Reasonable email support during working hours.

What is not included

- Paid advertising spend (for example Facebook or Google Ads budgets).
 - Copywriting, photography, or logo design unless listed above.
 - Third-party subscriptions such as premium plugins, stock images, or domain renewals, unless agreed in writing.
 - Extra work beyond the included revisions, which is billed as set out in section 6.
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3 Ownership of the website

Ownership is simple, and it depends on payment.

- Until the website is paid for in full, the design, files, and code remain the property of the service provider.
- Once all agreed fees are paid up to date, the client owns the final website content and design, and may take it elsewhere.
- The domain name belongs to the client. If the provider registered it on the client's behalf, it will be transferred to the client on request, with any registrar cost passed on at actual cost.
- Third-party components (such as plugins, fonts, or stock images) stay under their own licences and are not owned outright by either party.

Plain version: pay in full, and the website is yours to move wherever you like. This protects both sides and avoids the "who owns it" argument later.

4 Hosting (please read)

Hosting is the monthly cost of the server that keeps the website online and reachable by visitors. It is a third-party running cost, not a design fee. Without it, the site goes offline for everyone.

- Hosting is charged at [HOSTING_RATE] per month, shown separately on every invoice.
- While hosted on the provider's account, the provider keeps the site online for as long as hosting is paid.
- If hosting is not paid, the provider will give [e.g. 7] days written notice before the site is taken offline.
- The client may move the website to their own hosting at any time. The provider will hand over the files and assist with a clean transfer.

Why this is spelled out: hosting was the thing that caused confusion before. It is stated clearly here so it is never a surprise again.

5 Fees and payment terms

Set the numbers below. The totals update as you type. Currency symbol:

R

One-off setup / build fee	Monthly service fee (design + SEO)
R 0	R 0
Hosting per month	Deposit required to start (percent)
R 0	50 %
Extra revision / hourly rate	Estimated extra hours this month
R 0	0 hrs
TO START (DEPOSIT + HOSTING) R0 deposit 0 (50% of setup) + hosting 0	ONGOING PER MONTH R0 service 0 + hosting 0

Payment terms

- A deposit of the percentage above is required before work starts.
- Monthly fees and hosting are billed on the [1st] of each month, due within [7] days.
- Late payments over [14] days may pause work and, for hosting, may lead to the site going offline after notice (section 4).
- Prices are fixed for [12] months, after which they may be reviewed with [30] days notice.

6 Revisions and extra work

- The monthly fee includes the number of revision rounds listed in section 2.
- Work beyond that, including new pages, redesigns, or new features, is quoted first and billed at the extra rate in section 5.
- No extra work starts without the client's written go-ahead. You will never be billed for something you did not approve.

7 SEO expectations

SEO takes time. Search engines need weeks to months before ranking and enquiry improvements show. Early months may show little movement, which is normal and not a sign of failure. No specific ranking, traffic, or lead volume is guaranteed, because those depend on factors outside any one person's control, including competition and search engine changes.

8 Ending the agreement and handover

- Either side may end this agreement with [30] days written notice.
 - All fees owed up to the end date remain payable.
 - On exit, and once payment is up to date, the provider will hand over the website files and help move it to hosting of the client's choice.
 - The provider will not hold a paid-up website hostage. Equally, the client will not expect a site to stay online while hosting is unpaid.
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9 Agreement and signatures

By signing, both sides confirm they have read and agree to the terms above.

Service provider signature

Name: [Your name]

Date: [/ /]

Client signature

Name: [Client name]

Date: [/ /]

This is a plain-language template, not formal legal advice. For high-value contracts, have it checked by a professional in your area. Version v0. Fields shown in blue are for you to complete.